

# Radical Presence

A PROJECTWEEK BY LAURA NSENGIYUMVA

In a world in transition to a post-colonial society, artists have an important role in re-imagining new ways to relate to each other.

Social struggles like ecology or queerness have already made their way into the art school, while addressing colonial history and its racial outcomes still seems to be disruptive to an apolitical conception of art.

Nevertheless, the future is now and we cannot condemn yet another generation to ignorance.

This introduction to **#ARTIVISM** wishes to expand your practice beyond the western canon of "art", to a place where community work, memory, and design are the colors on your palette. Those three eclectic days are composed for you to never get comfortable, but rather to learn actively and responsibly what this **#DECOLONIZATION** is about!

Day 1  
16-11

## DECOLONIZING MYSELF

Let's talk about race! This workshop is aimed to the ones willing to understand "whiteness" in its theoretic and emotional dimension.

In order to create a safer space for everyone, this workshop will be at some point split into two groups. only reserved for students perceived as white. The point is to free you from the political correctness pressure, to not be afraid to make mistakes and truly explore the

9 > 10

BODY PRACTICE

10 > 12

DECOLONIAL ART (LECTURE)

learning colonial history through art

Laura Nsengiyumva

12 > 13

LUNCH

13 > 17

### DECONSTRUCT WHITENESS

Johanna Couvée

All around us we can find ignorance and resistance to concepts such as **whiteness, white privilege and white fragility**. By deepening our knowledge of these concepts and examining them **in relation to ourselves**, we can give **space to our discomfort** and take up the fight against oppressive mechanisms within and around ourselves.

Together we will explore what whiteness means and how it functions in and around ourselves. How has whiteness made us who we are and how do we unjustly benefit from it?

We therefore also make space for conversation and **inner work**: What does this theme do to us within? And what can we do to dismantle whiteness? By working with these questions, we make movement beyond white fragility, through our discomfort, towards recognition and reparation.

*Johanna Couvée is a cultural worker, curator and consultant working for Citylab @citylab.brussels. Trained as a sociologist and somatic psychologist, she explores ways to connect therapeutic practices, collective action and social justice.*

### SURVIVING WHITENESS

Saadia Sahraoui

*If you don't identify as white*, chances are that you experienced quite a lot of #cognitivedissonance within the art school, the art sector, and this country in general. From frontal discriminations, to micro-agressions, or simply to the ignorance of your peers, all those life experiences **will not be your responsibility to explain, but to heal from**.

This workshop is made for you to learn about **#RADICALSELFCARE**, as a starting point of your own healing journey. That conception of self-care includes a community dimension by offering a space for psychic solidarity and empathetic sharing, with the positive mirror that the other can be.

Saadia will also share tools and resources to better understand and manage one's existence in spaces where structural domination is difficult to live.

*Initially trained in the field of psychology, Saadia Sahraoui has worked her way through different and plural practices : in psychiatry, private practice, youth sector and academic research.*

## Day 2 **ART FOR #ALLYSHIP**

17-11

Let's talk about allyship ! What if activism started by to be the . This day is dedicated to serve the grassroots sector from a mutual standpoint . As we learn on Belgian activist #herstory, strategy, community work, etc, we offer our skills and creativity in return. To understand the esthetic of emergency. You can choose between two activities:

### **HOTM** **online presence** *Geeky*

The HoTM ( Headquarters of the movement) was born from the ashes of LeSpace, after its eviction, the activist hub in Brussels from wich started many decolonial actions, included Queen Nikkolah.

Since 2020, HoTM is the discreet driving force behind the last revolutionary campaigns in Belgium ; **Justice For Mawda**, U:Nite, and **In My Name** ( for the legalization of undocumented refugees) . HoTM is the invisible missing link between many grassroots organizations.

Collectively recovering from activist burn-outs, HoTM is in need of practical help **for the creation on an online platform; visual identity, etc.**

### **QUEEN NIKKOLAH** **outfits** *Crafty*

Queen Nikkolah is the grassroot alternative to Sinterklaas that challenges the limits of race and gender of Belgian folklore. Since 2017, Queen Nikkolah has grown from a performance to a real tradition, by becoming Immaterial Heritage in 2020.

Each year, the outfits of QN are improvised in the precarious time management, which brought an esthetic of **second hand**, handcraft, etc. This year, **artists of Kask are invited to co-design and restore, the outfits of the two Queens** (L.Nsengiyumva and poet Mimi Waterfall), as an act of allyship.

We aim for a positive cross-cultural exchange, and **a deep conversation on cultural appropriation** in fashion.

**9 > 10**

**PRESENTATION HOTM**  
Rachida Aziz

**10 > 17**

**CO-CREATION**

**17 > 18**

**PRESENTATION**

**9.30 > 10**

**PRESENTATION QN**  
Laura Nsengiyumva

**10 > 18**

**CO-CREATION**

**18 > 18.30**

**PRESENTATION**

Day 3  
18-11

## DECOLONIZE THE CURRICULUM

Let's talk about responsibility! What if activism started locally? by taking the responsibility of our environment? Do student movements die out as their members graduate? Or do they come in waves as new students arrive? We will reignite the imprint left by "Decolonize The Curriculum", a student initiative of 2018 to feminize and decolonize the knowledge of their art education in Kask. Similar interconnected movements were active in the surrounding art schools in Europe ; The Alliance, We Cannot work like this, while new ones appear. For our radical presence, we will co-create an activist action within the the school around those revindications.

Practical info

### SUBSCRIBE !!!

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